Responding to Emergency in Israel

Urgent Funding Needs, March 4, 2026

Israel Again in the Shadow of War

Over the past few days, Israel was once again thrown into war. In the last 100 hours, hundreds of missiles and drones were launched from Iran – and more recently, Lebanon – to Israel, sending millions of Israelis to safe rooms and bomb shelters at all hours of the day and night. While most were intercepted, as of March 3rd, direct hits in Tel Aviv, Beit Shemesh, Jerusalem, and Be'er Sheva caused 12 fatalities, hundreds of injuries, and extensive damage to homes and infrastructure, forcing over 1,500 citizens to leave their homes and evacuate to hotels.

As this crisis unfolds, JDC is there. Since the first news of the attacks, JDC drew on its established networks of government ministries and local partners to assess emerging needs and explore possible solutions.

We have not worked in a vacuum. Using unrestricted and emergency funding, even before October 7th, JDC has created strong foundations that allowed us to act quickly and effectively, in real time. For example:

- **Digital Tools:** JDC-developed platforms, from web sites for education and mental health professionals to AI-powered support apps for reservists' spouses and data dashboards for multi-ministerial round tables, continue to anchor the digital infrastructure that is being expanded upon today to help vulnerable populations receive critical responses and services.
- **Municipal Partnership:** Our work with municipalities, strengthening community resilience through *Mashiv Haruach*, helping local municipalities meet urgent humanitarian needs, and building local capacity through the Northern Initiative and other programs – has reinforced JDC's role as a trusted convener and facilitator that promotes effective and efficient work among local and national bodies.
- **Leveling the Playing Field in Critical Aid:** To reduce disparities in emergency medical readiness, JDC equipped volunteer response teams in low-income

municipalities with Advanced Life Support, Basic Life Support, and CPR kits, and established locally based Emergency Medical Units stocked to help treat urgent casualties. JDC continues to monitor these needs in an effort to close critical gaps.

With our partners and supporters' aid, we have been able to do so much. But the new needs continue to emerge, and our ability to continue this lifesaving work throughout the current conflict depends on you. The following funding menu outlines the most urgent priorities, now, and in the difficult days ahead.

Highlighted Urgent Funding Needs:

1. **Humanitarian Relief for Directly Hit Cities**
   Support for cities absorbing massive, direct missile damage (e.g., Beit Shemesh, Be'er Sheva).
   $200,000 per city x 5 cities

In response to the fatal strike and severe damage in Beit Shemesh, JDC immediately offered multi-layered emergency support. Designed to address both urgent humanitarian needs and the emerging challenges facing vulnerable populations, JDC has been offering similar support to hard-hit cities since October 7th. JDC has started to offer the following assistance in Beit Shemesh and is expanding to Be'er Sheva. Further expansion into additional cities will be considered as the conflict develops.

- **Immediate Humanitarian Relief:** Items such as clothing and essential supplies for families, delivered in partnership with the *Shinua Hevrati* organization. This includes toiletries, clothing, basic necessities, and special items for children. Additional assistance will be provided as necessary.
- **Emergency Readiness and Medical Equipment:** Medical and first response equipment for municipal emergency teams, ranging from tourniquets and bandages to stretchers, advanced and basic lifesaving kits, and rescue kits. These tools will strengthen the city's capacity to respond effectively to ongoing risks.
- **Flexible Humanitarian Assistance Fund:** A dedicated flexible fund will enable the municipality to address its most urgent needs.
- **Deployment of Community Caseworkers:** Two full-time community caseworkers will reinforce the municipal welfare department, increasing vulnerable populations' access to public rights and services in the aftermath of the attacks.

This response builds on JDC's proven municipal partnership model, deploying flexible, targeted support to vulnerable residents. Activated during the 2025 missile attacks, it enabled rapid stabilization and strengthened local crisis response capacity.

2. **Welfare Support for Northern Frontline Municipalities**
   Support for Low-Socio-Economic Authorities in the North struggling after two years of conflict.
   $150,000 per city x 10 cities

Following the escalation on the Lebanese border, JDC has received urgent appeals from seven municipalities where JDC operates - Ma'ale Yosef, Shlomi, Kiryat Shmona, Nahariya, Hurfeish, Deir al-Asad, and Mevo'ot Hermon. Requested support includes food, essential household supplies, mattresses, biodegradable and accessible medical equipment, community support personnel, resilience and training packages, activity kits, and emergency relief operations. We anticipate the demand to increase as the war continues to evolve.

JDC is active in 24 locations along the northern confrontation line and is prepared to launch immediate operations in all areas.

3. **All the Way Home (*Ad HaBayit*) Program for Families Whose Apartments Were Severely Damaged: $3,300,000**

In the wake of Iran's missile attacks, a growing number of Israelis are finding themselves suddenly homeless, forced to flee damaged apartments and take refuge in hotel rooms, unsure of what comes next. In the June war with Iran, some 13,000 Israelis were displaced, including 4,000 particularly vulnerable populations. Without dedicated support, many, overwhelmed by the trauma and loss of the attack, unequipped to deal with lengthy processes and government bureaucracy, are at risk of falling through the cracks.

All the Way Home will provide personalized housing transition support for up to 300 of the most vulnerable households in hard-hit cities. Working in cooperation with local municipalities and NGO's, the program helps displaced residents access rights, navigate a complicated bureaucracy, and find viable housing. We have already identified 100 families in need and expect demand to grow in the coming days and weeks.

4. **Increasing Accessibility in Shelters for People with Disabilities and Accessible Shelter Kits for Children: $200,000**

Many people with disabilities live in homes without private shelters and must relocate to public bomb shelters during emergencies. The frequent rocket attacks since October 7 have revealed critical accessibility gaps, both physical barriers inside shelters and the emotional strain placed on people with disabilities, including young children, during prolonged stays.

While efforts are underway to address these gaps, comprehensive solutions take time, even as the need grows more urgent with each escalation and with increasingly destructive missile threats from Iran. JDC seeks to advance an inclusive, practical response that supports both physical access and emotional well-being by:

- **Equipping municipalities with essential accessibility tools,** including equipment such as portable ramps, marked stairs and thresholds, guiding strips, and specialized signage, alongside training for staff and emergency volunteers on how to implement and maintain these adaptations.
- **Providing accessible shelter kits** intended to help children reduce distress, manage their emotions, and keep them engaged and able to function. Kits include items such as small pop-up tents, weighted blankets, cozy floor mats, and noise-canceling headphones.

5. **Emergency Replacement of Medical Gas Cylinders: $576,000**

In light of a mid-February 2026 directive from the Ministry of Health (MOH) finding safety concerns with existing cylinders contained in some of these kits, JDC seeks to urgently procure new, certified oxygen cylinders for municipal volunteer response teams. JDC will secure 300 cylinders immediately, with the remaining 1,142 to be obtained within one to three weeks, subject to availability amid rising national demand. The plan includes centralized collection and phased replacement of affected cylinders, with close coordination with both the Ministry of Health and other national authorities to ensure uninterrupted life-saving capacity for vulnerable communities during ongoing attacks on Israel's home front.

6. **Increased Needs of Global Jewish Communities: $300,000**

JDC is closely monitoring the situation across Europe, Asia and Africa regions, staying in constant contact with local leadership and identifying new needs. Drawing on our longstanding and trusted partnerships with leadership across the region, we are helping partners activate response channels that we have been developing and supporting — security, mental health support, communal networks and more.

In the Netherlands, vulnerable Jewish students and families with close ties to Israel urgently require expanded social work and mental-health assistance, along with bolstered crisis-response systems that serve both stranded foreigners and local community members. Across Turkey, France, Brussels, and Tunisia, communities are experiencing acute increases in security threats that are intensifying around schools, synagogues, youth movements, and major communal gatherings. JDC aims to help these regions absorb rapidly rising security costs and reinforce protective infrastructure at a moment of heightened risk. These interventions are essential to safeguarding Jewish life and ensuring that vulnerable individuals and community institutions remain supported and protected.

Summary of Funding Needs*

Program	**Funding Need**
Humanitarian Relief for Directly Hit Cities ($200,000 per city x 5 cities)	$1,000,000
Welfare Support for Northern Frontline Municipalities ($150,000 per city x 10 cities)	$1,500,000
All the Way Home for Families Whose Apartments Were Severely Damaged	$3,300,000
Increasing Accessibility in Shelters for People with Disabilities and Accessible Shelter Kits for Children	$200,000
Emergency Replacement of Medical Gas Cylinders	$576,000
Increased Needs of Global Jewish Communities	$300,000
Total	**$6,876,000**

*As of March 04, subject to change as the situation develops